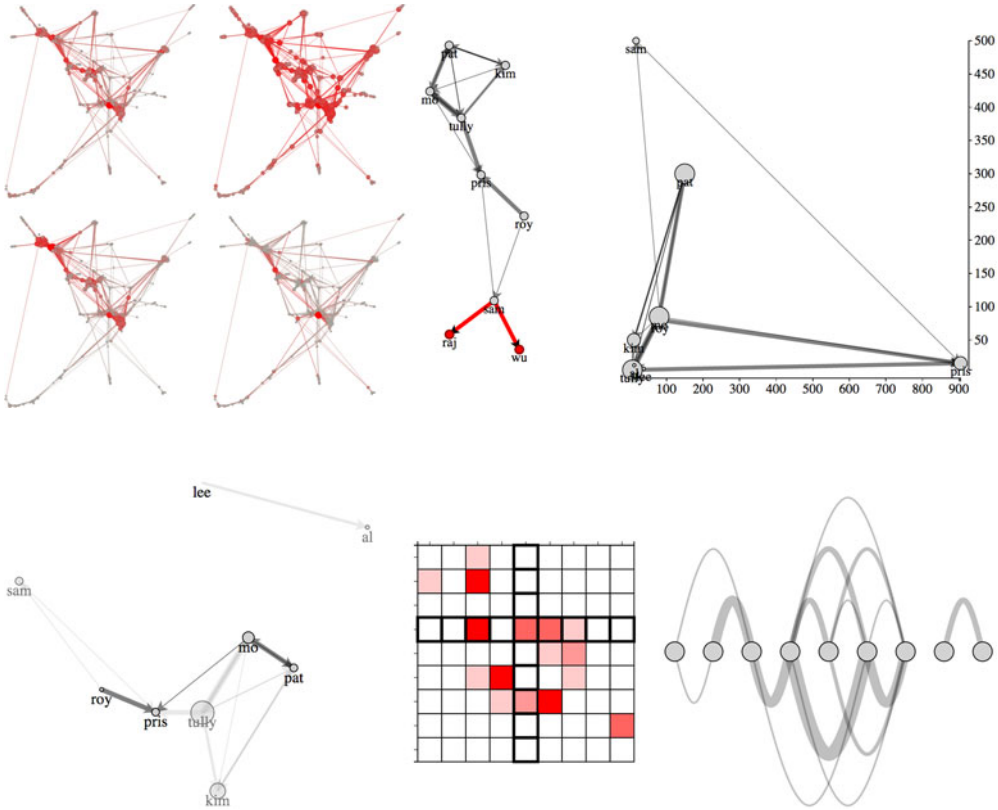



**Figure 6.1 Along with explaining the basics of network analysis (section 6.2.3), this chapter includes laying out networks using xy positioning (section 6.2.5), force-directed algorithms (section 6.2), adjacency matrices (section 6.1.2), and arc diagrams (section 6.1.3).**

*graphs*, because that's what they're called in mathematics. Finally, the importance of a node in a network is typically referred to as *centrality*. There's more, but that should be enough to get you started.

Networks aren't just a data format; they're a perspective on data. When you work with network data, you typically try to discover and display patterns of the network or of parts of the network, and not of individual nodes in the network. Although you may use a network visualization because it makes a cool graphical index, like a mind map or a network map of a website, in general you'll find that the typical information visualization techniques are designed to showcase network structure, and not individual nodes.

## 6.1 Static network diagrams

Network data is different from hierarchical data. Networks present the possibility of many-to-many connections, like the Sankey layout from chapter 5, whereas in hierarchical data a node can have many children but only one parent, like the tree and pack